
User Interfaces

Ana Balula | Technical English

User Interfaces

User Interface:

method by which **the user and the computer exchange information and instructions.**

There are three main types – **command-line**, **menu driven** and **graphical user interface (GUI).**

Graphical User Interface (GUI /gu:i/):

a type of user interface that allows users to interact with electronic devices through **graphical icons** and **visual indicators** such as secondary notation, instead of text-based user interfaces, typed command labels or text navigation.

Command Line Interface (CLI):

a **text-based** user interface used to **view and manage computer files**. Command line interfaces are also called command-line user interfaces, console user interfaces and character user interfaces.

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Advantages of GUI

- ❑ Easy to use due to the visual nature of the interface.
- ❑ The user has lots of visual clues as to what things do.
- ❑ Less chance of user input errors.
- ❑ Quicker to input commands.

Disadvantages of GUI

- ❑ To display all of the nice graphics required by a GUI takes a lot of computing power so quite a powerful computer is needed.
- ❑ User restricted to pre-determined options.

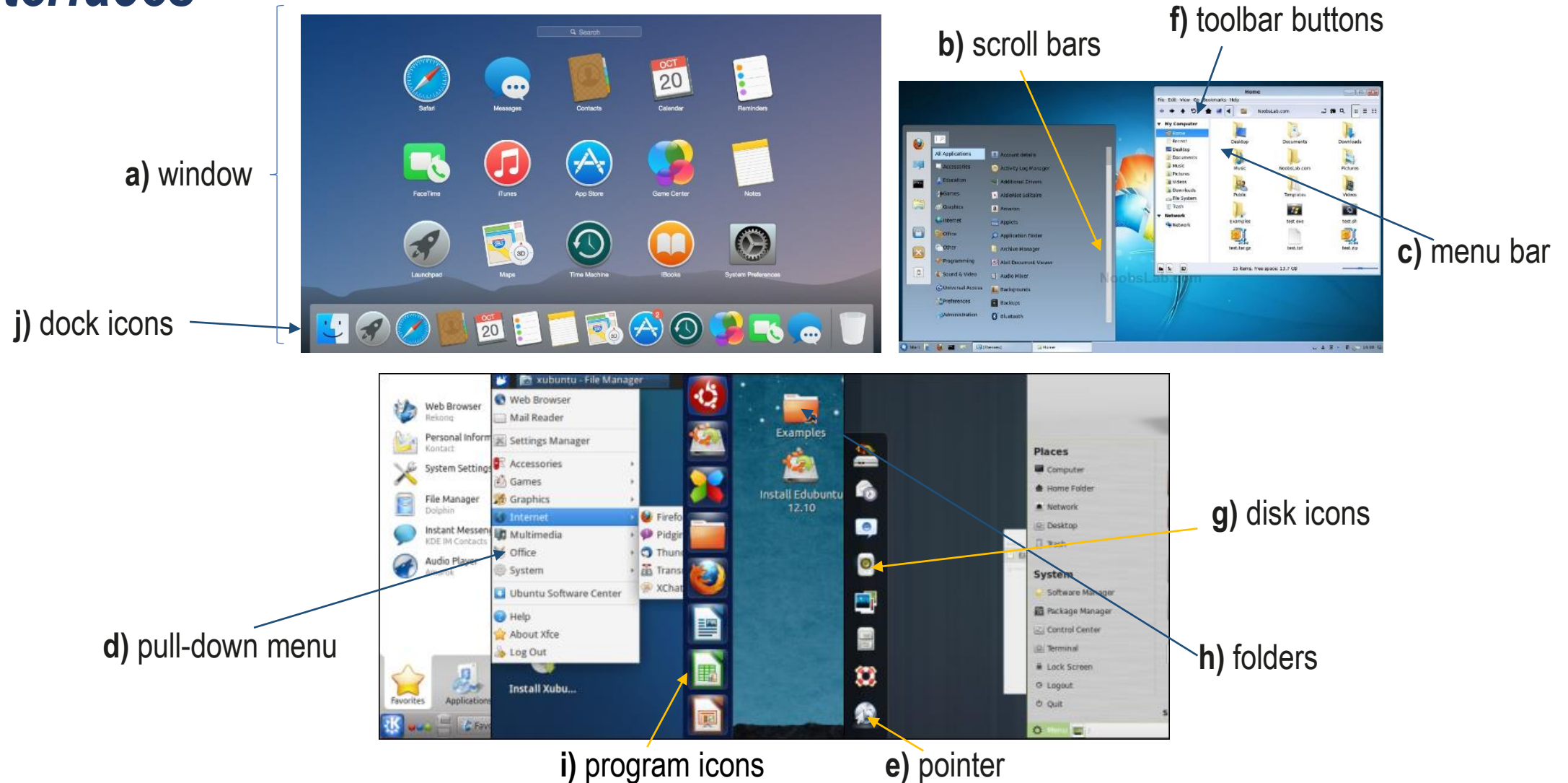
Advantages of CLI

- ❑ The User has direct communication with computer.
- ❑ Has a wider range of commands to use.

Disadvantages of CLI

- ❑ User must remember complex commands.
- ❑ Lots of typing needed for quite simple tasks.

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User Interfaces

WIMP

displays
self-explanatory
documents
programs
arrow
options
drop-down/ pull down
desktop
user-friendly

A GUI makes use of a **WIMP** environment: **Windows**, **Icons**, **Menus** and **Pointer**.

This type of interface is _____.

System functions are accessed by selecting _____ **icons** (pictures representing _____ or _____) and items from menus (_____).

The **pointer** is the _____ controlled by the mouse, which lets you choose _____ from menus.

The background screen that _____ icons, representing programs, files and folders (directories) is called the _____.

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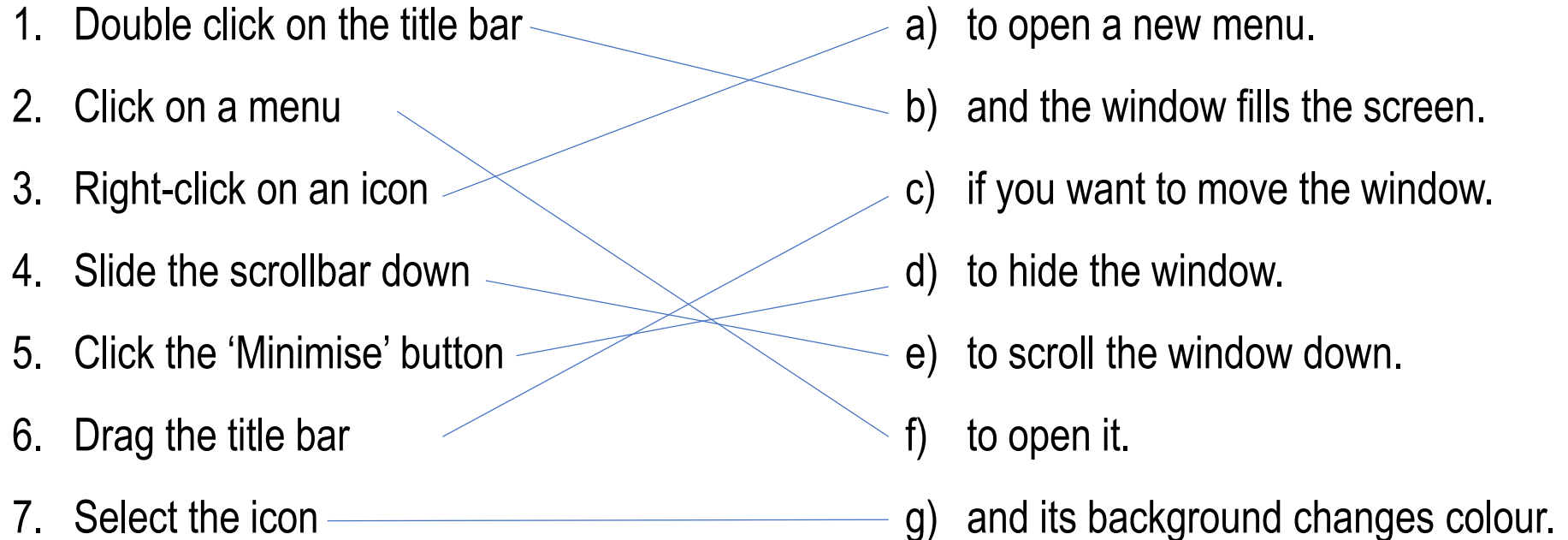
System functions are accessed by selecting self-explanatory **icons** (pictures representing programs or documents) and items from menus (drop-down/ pull down).

The **pointer** is the arrow controlled by the mouse, which lets you choose options from menus.

The background screen that displays icons, representing programs, files and folders (directories) is called the desktop.

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GUI operations

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- A diagram showing seven GUI operations on the left and seven purposes on the right, connected by blue lines. The connections are as follows: 1. Double click on the title bar connects to f) to open it. 2. Click on a menu connects to a) to open a new menu. 3. Right-click on an icon connects to b) and the window fills the screen. 4. Slide the scrollbar down connects to e) to scroll the window down. 5. Click the 'Minimise' button connects to d) to hide the window. 6. Drag the title bar connects to c) if you want to move the window. 7. Select the icon connects to g) and its background changes colour.
1. Double click on the title bar
 2. Click on a menu
 3. Right-click on an icon
 4. Slide the scrollbar down
 5. Click the 'Minimise' button
 6. Drag the title bar
 7. Select the icon
- a) to open a new menu.
 - b) and the window fills the screen.
 - c) if you want to move the window.
 - d) to hide the window.
 - e) to scroll the window down.
 - f) to open it.
 - g) and its background changes colour.

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